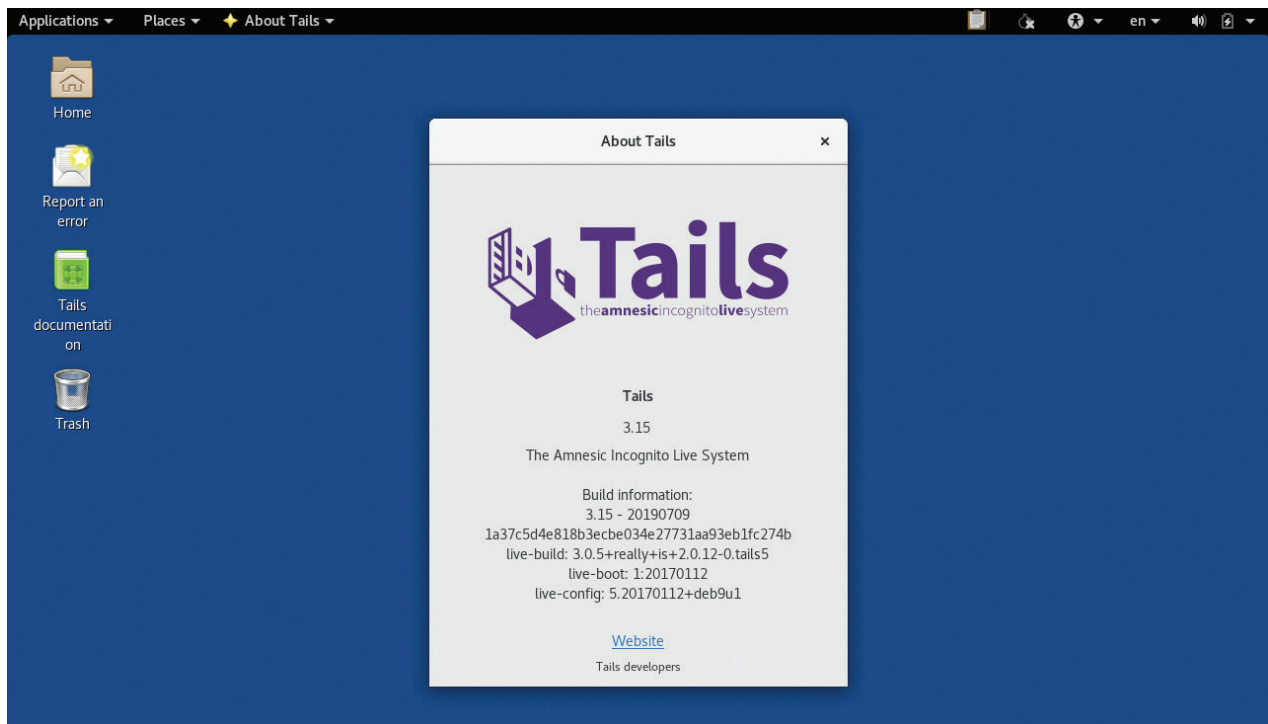




8. Do not enter a real name, phone number, address or identifying email.
9. View PDFs inside the built-in viewer when practical; do not casually open them externally.
10. End the session when changing identities or purposes.

Tor cannot guarantee perfect anonymity. A website can identify you when you sign in or reveal personal details. A powerful observer able to compare traffic entering and leaving the network may attempt correlation. Tor may be slower or blocked by some websites.

Combining a VPN with Tor is not automatically safer. The Tor Project generally advises against doing so unless an advanced user understands the configuration and its consequences. A badly designed combination can introduce a stable account, extra logs or routing failures.

Bridges conceal ordinary Tor entry points

A local network can often recognise that you are connecting to public Tor relays, even if it cannot see the final site. Bridges are non-public entry relays intended to help when Tor connections are blocked or when ordinary relay lists are filtered. They do not make Tor perfect or hide every traffic pattern.

To request a bridge on desktop:

1. Open Tor Browser's Settings > Connection.
2. Locate Bridges.
3. Request a bridge through the built-in process or enter addresses obtained through an official Tor channel.

4. Add each bridge exactly as supplied.
5. Connect and replace the bridge if it no longer works.

Tails provides a separate high-sensitivity environment

Tails is a portable operating system designed to start from a USB drive and route its internet activity through Tor. By default, activity disappears when Tails shuts down. Users can optionally create encrypted Persistent Storage for selected files and settings. Tails itself warns that it is not magic: metadata, mixed identities, compromised firmware and powerful traffic analysis can still defeat privacy.

Download Tails from its official site, verify the image and install it to a dedicated USB drive. Restart between unrelated high-sensitivity activities, and avoid sharing persistent storage across identities.

Choose by observer, not by brand

Use HTTPS for every sensitive website. Use private DNS to reduce exposure of domain lookups. Use a proxy when one application needs a controlled route. Use a reputable VPN when you need to shift trust away from the local network or ISP. Use Tor Browser when separating the origin of web activity matters more than speed and convenience. Consider Tails for higher-sensitivity sessions requiring a temporary operating environment.

No option removes trust. It redistributes it. Draw the route, name every observer and decide which one you are prepared to trust with each piece of information. That habit is more valuable than any logo promising one-click invisibility. **d**